COMPLIANCE

⚠ CRITICAL

SURPRISE REGULATORY AUDIT

Regulators have arrived unannounced. They are requesting evidence of data handling policies, access controls, audit logs, and breach response procedures — immediately. You have a few hours before they expect documentation on the table.

Regulatory audits test whether compliance is a living practice or a periodic paper exercise. The evidence regulators seek — access logs, change records, data processing agreements, incident response tests, security scan results — is generated continuously by mature DevOps practices and captured as artefacts. Policy as Code (using tools like Open Policy Agent or AWS Config Rules) automates compliance checks on every deployment, generating audit evidence as a by-product of normal operations. A compliance dashboard showing current control status, last-tested dates, and evidence links turns an audit from a crisis into a scheduled data export. GDPR, ISO 27001, and SOC 2 all reward organisations that can demonstrate continuous control, not point-in-time remediation.

Compliance is not something you do before an audit. It is something you demonstrate you have always been doing.

TEAM DISCUSSION

Can you produce a complete audit trail of who accessed what data, when, and why — in the next 30 minutes?